# Deploying a Zoho Creator Application from Development to Production Environment

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## Abstract

This experiment documents the release flow of a Zoho Creator application through its environments. The GYM MEMBERSHIP application was built and tested in the Development environment, and the procedure for deploying it to Stage and then to Production is described together with the evidence available in the lab account.

## 1. Aim

To deploy a Zoho Creator application from the Development environment to the Stage and then the Production environment.

### Note on Execution

Deploying to Stage and Production needs a paid Zoho Creator plan. If the lab account is on a free or expired trial, the experiment is documented as a procedure together with the evidence that could be captured, and steps that could not be executed are marked as such.

## 2. Concepts

**Environments.** Zoho Creator provides three environments: Development (build and test changes), Stage (test with realistic data before release) and Production (the live application used by real users).

**Deployment.** The application structure (forms, reports, workflows, pages) is promoted from one environment to the next. Each environment has its own data and its own URL, shown in the address bar as /environment/development, /environment/stage or /environment/production.

**Why use them.** Developers can change and test the application without disturbing live users, and a tested version is promoted unchanged. For the gym application, this keeps the front desk's daily attendance and fee updates safe while new reports are being tried.

## 3. Procedure

1. Build and test the application in the Development environment. Every form, report, dashboard and workflow of GYM MEMBERSHIP is created here, and the live view is opened with Access Development Live.
2. Confirm that the address bar of the live application contains /environment/development and that the Development label is shown in the top bar (Figure 2).
3. Open the deployment option of the application and choose Deploy to Stage; review the components list, add a description such as Release 1 and confirm.
4. Test the application in Stage, including the Membership Enrollment Form and its confirmation email workflow.
5. Choose Deploy to Production from Stage and confirm, then verify the application at /environment/production.
6. Make later changes only in Development and deploy them again, so that Production stays stable between releases.

## 4. Implementation Screenshots (GYM MEMBERSHIP application)




*Figure 1: Release flow of Zoho Creator environments (diagram)*

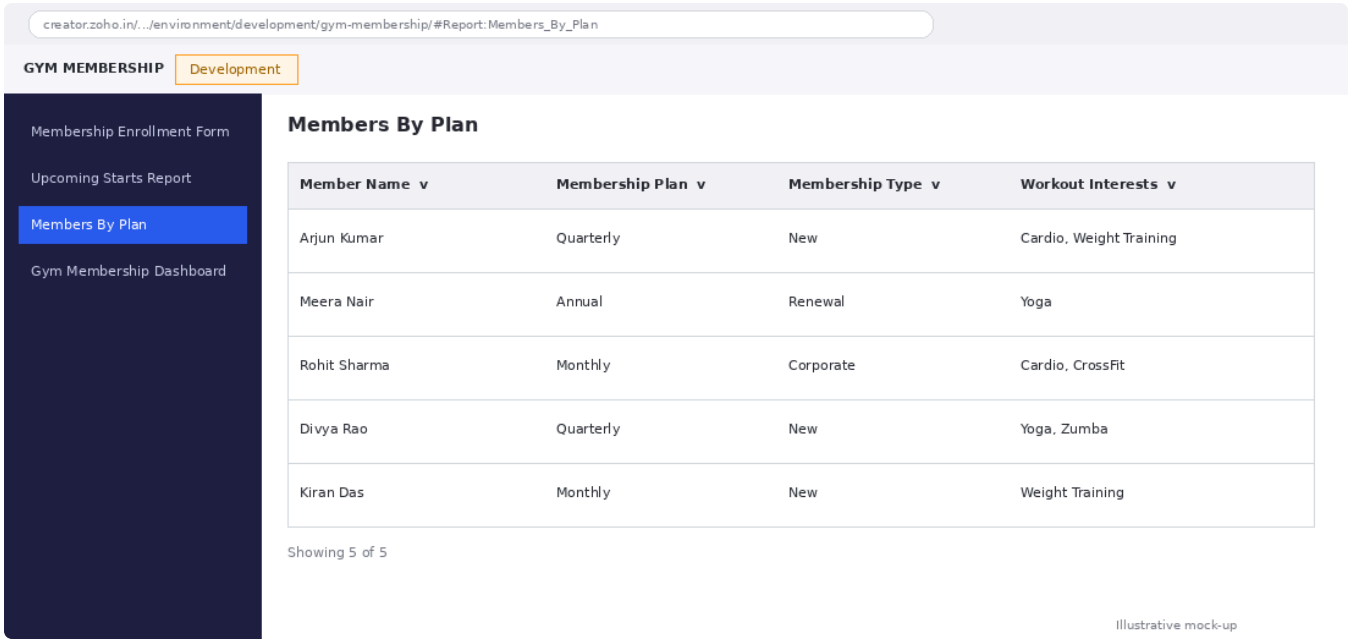



*Figure 2: Members By Plan live in the Development environment, with the Development label and the /environment/development address*

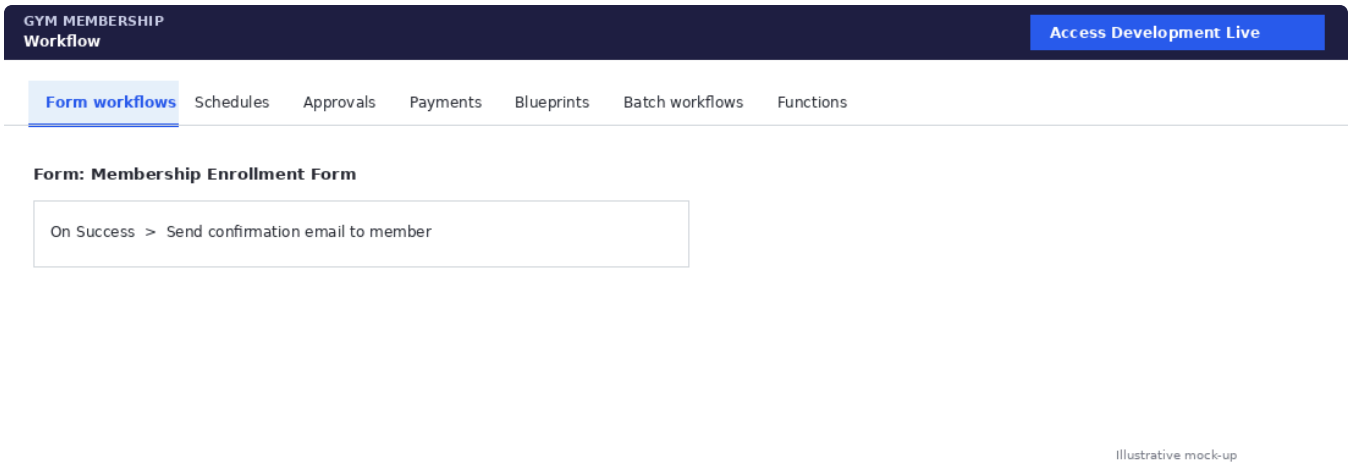



*Figure 3: Workflow page of GYM MEMBERSHIP with the Access Development Live option*

## 5. Expected Output

The same forms, reports, dashboard and workflow would be available in Stage and Production, each with its own URL, and later Development changes would not appear in Production until they are deployed.

## 6. Result

The application was built, tested and run in the Development environment, and the environment is identified in the live view by its label and URL. Deployment to Stage and Production needs a paid plan; where the lab account could not execute those steps, they are documented as the procedure above.

## 7. Learning Outcome

Learnt the Development, Stage and Production release flow of Zoho Creator, how each environment is identified by its URL, and why testing in Stage protects live users.